

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6
♥ 7 6
♦ 8 7 6 5
♣ Q J 9 8 7

♠ A Q 3 2

♥ 5 4 3

♦ 4 3 2

♣ 4 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 8

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ 10 9

♣ 10 6 5

♠ K 5 4

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			

Never mind the bidding. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♣Q.

You have 12 top tricks. There are no finesses available, but a 3-3 split in either Major suit will provide the 13th trick. As you can see, this is not going to happen.

But there is another possibility; if the same defender holds 4 ♥s and 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him in those two suits.

You win the ♣K and play ♥ A K Q to test the ♥ suit, but West discards a ♣ on the ♥Q. (You tested ♥s first because of dummy's limited entries to the ♠ suit.)

Your ♥2 is not a winner but is a **THREAT** to become one. East holds the ♥J which is a **GUARD** against that happening.

Next play your 4 ♦ winners, discarding a ♣ from dummy. East follows twice, then starts to feel the pressure. He cannot discard the ♥J because it is guarding your ♥2, and since he can see those 4 ♠s in dummy he doesn't want to discard a ♠. He discards both his ♣s, trusting West to guard that suit.

Now you play the ♣A. At this point you are still hoping the ♠s will split 3-3. They aren't going to, as you see, but something wonderful happens instead. East cannot discard his ♥J because to do so would establish your ♥2. So he must throw a ♠ instead. You realize your ♥2 is not a winner so you just play ♠K, ♠A and ♠Q, and amazingly dummy's ♠3 has become your thirteenth trick.

Of course if East had discarded his ♥J you would have cashed your ♥2 and then taken three ♠ winners.

You just executed a Squeeze Play and you didn't even have to try.

This type of squeeze is called an **automatic squeeze** because it operates equally well against either defender. Suppose the EW hands were switched. Of course the opening lead would have been different, but when you were ready to play your ninth winner the hands would have looked like this.

This time it is West who holds the only Guards in both ♠s and ♥s.

You play the ♣A and he must give up one of those Guards.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ A K 10 2
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ 10 3

♠ 9 7 5
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ Q 7 4 2
♣ 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 3
♥ J 9 7 5 4
♦ 8 6
♣ 5 2

♠ A K 4
♥ -
♦ A K 5
♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	7♣
All Pass			
7♣ by South			

Play the ♠ A K and West begins to feel the heat.

On the ♠ K you discarded dummy's small ♥ and West also discarded a ♥.

But now you play the SQUEEZE card, the ♣ A. West absolutely cannot throw away his ♥ A, so he discards a ♦ instead.

Since he still has the ♥ A you know dummy's ♥ Q is useless so you discard it. Dummy's fourth ♦ has become a winner.

This type of squeeze is called a **positional squeeze** because it only operates against one of the defenders. Suppose the EW hands were switched as shown below. When you were ready to play the Squeeze Card the hands would have looked like this.

East holds the only Guards in both red suits, but he cannot be squeezed.

You must play from dummy **BEFORE** East plays, so he just matches whatever you do.

If you discard the ♥ Q East will throw his ♥ A. If you discard dummy's fourth ♦, East will throw his fourth ♦.

South is to play 7♣. West leads the ♥ K.

South is to play 7♣. West leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 sure winners in your hand and dummy's ♦ Q makes 12. Your main hope is for a 3-3 ♦ split in which case dummy's fourth ♦ will be a winner.

But there is another possibility in case the ♦ s don't split. Dummy's ♥ Q is a **THREAT** card which is **GUARDED** only by West's ♥ A. If it is West who has the 4 ♦ s you will be able to squeeze him.

You ruff the ♥ K and play 5 more ♣ winners, being careful not to discard a ♦ or the ♥ Q from dummy.

With everybody down to 7 cards this is the position. East's hand is important only in that he must hold on to his ♠ stopper. West must keep the ♥ A and all four ♦ s.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5
♥ 10 7 5 2
♦ 10 3
♣ K Q J 4 2

♠ A K 7 3

♥ Q 9 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ A 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 6 2

♥ 8 4

♦ J 9 8 4

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A K J 6

♦ K Q 7 2

♣ 10 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT

Pass 6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

you can afford to lose, which in this hand is exactly one trick. So you duck the ♣K and win the next trick when West continues with the ♣Q.

AHA! The count is rectified, so now you play your ♥ winners.

East has no problems on the first 3, he just plays his 2 ♥s and 1 ♣.

Here is the situation just as you are about to play the Squeeze Card, the ♥A.

You will toss dummy's ♣8 and East will have to decide whether it is better for him to throw a ♠ or a ♦. He doesn't know that discarding either one is going to hand you the contract, so he will probably discard a ♦.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♣K.

You have 11 winners, 3 ♠s, 4 ♥s, 3 ♦s and 1 ♣. If either ♠s or ♦s split 3-3 that would give you your 12th trick. If both split 3-3 you can make all thirteen tricks.

As you see, neither of them splits. However since one defender, East in this case, holds both Guards you should be able to squeeze him.

Visualize what would happen, though, if you win the first trick and then play your 4 ♥ winners. East would play his 3 ♣s and 2 ♥s on those 5 tricks and he would not be squeezed. The problem is that you have to **RECTIFY THE COUNT**.

To rectify the count you have to lose all the tricks